

From the pre charts to the current charts

FDA FAERS, fourth quarter of 2025. Same extract. Two ways of counting.

The charts in *archive/* are the pre counts. The charts in *result/* are the current counts. Both start from the same 385,288 FAERS cases. This file already holds one row per case, so the latest-version step does not change which cases enter the count. What changes is the unit being counted.

Two units

The pre count pairs every drug row on a case with every reaction row on that case. A case with a long drug list and a long reaction list contributes many pairs. The current count keeps one drug name per case and one reaction term per case. Every case then has the same weight, whatever the length of its list.

The pre count is useful when the question is how often a name sits inside those pairs. The current count is useful when the question is how many cases name the drug or report the reaction.

	Pre (archive)	Current (result)
Unit	Drug row paired with reaction row	One name per case
A long list	Adds many pairs	Still counts as one case
Drug bar	Pair volume for that name	Cases that name the drug
Reaction bar	Pair volume for that term	Cases that report the term

What moves

Methotrexate cases in this extract list about 42 drug rows and about 12 reactions. Dupixent cases list about 3 drug rows and about 3 reactions. Under the pre count, methotrexate, Actemra, and sulfasalazine lead the drug chart because those cases produce many pairs. Under the current count, Dupixent leads, with 36,464 cases.

Off-label use is about 389,000 on the pre reaction chart. The current chart shows 26,853 cases. Death moves the other way: it is easier to see once each case is counted once, at 13,241 cases.

Item	Pre	Current
Leading drug	Methotrexate	Dupixent, 36,464 cases
Off-label use	About 389,000 pairs	26,853 cases
Death	Lower on the pair chart	13,241 cases

Serious and non-serious sample

Both versions draw the same 5,000 serious cases and 5,000 non-serious cases. A serious case has an outcome code for death, a life-threatening event, hospitalisation, disability, a congenital anomaly, or a required intervention. The pre share multiplies each reaction by the number of drug rows on the case. The current share gives the reaction one count per case, then divides by the reaction rows in that group.

In the current serious sample, Death is 2.47% of reaction terms, off-label use is 1.53%, and diarrhoea is 1.03%. In the non-serious sample, off-label use is 2.34%, drug ineffective is 1.95%, and product dose omission is 1.72%. Across the pooled sample, off-label use is 1.84% and Death is 1.53%.

The comparison file *reaction_comparison_table.csv* follows the pre count. An empty cell means the term was outside that column's own top 10. The current charts fill each listed term with its share in every column. A current drug count includes concomitant drugs. A current sample percentage is a share of reaction terms in the balanced sample, not a share of all 385,288 cases.